MIL-I-43052A(IH)
30 September 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-43052(QMC)
28 December 1961

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, GRADE, SHOULDER LOOP SLEEVE, ROTC AND JROTC, ARMY

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers the requirements for shoulder loop sleeves plain and embroidered with insignia of grade.

1.2 Classification.- The sleeves shall be of one type in the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1 - Master Sergent
Class 2 - First Sergeant
Class 3 - Sergeant First Class
Class 4 - Staff Sergeant
Class 5 - Sergeant
Class 6 - Corporal
Class 7 - Private First Class
Class 8 - Sergeant Major
Class 9 - Command Sergeant Major
Class 10 - Private
Class 11 - Cadet Officer, JROTC, Female

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL
V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton
CCC-C-461 - Cloth, Twill, Uniform Cotton
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup
MILITARY
MIL-I-3037 - Insignia, Emboridered, General Specification For
MIL-F-10884 - Fasteners, Snap
STANDARDS
FEDERAL
FED-STD-191 - Textile; Test Method
FED-STD-751 - Stitch; Seam, and Stitching

/FSC 8455/

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MILITARY
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS
THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY
B-3-79 - Insignia of Grade, ROTC, Cadets, Sergeant First Class to Command Sergeant Major
B-3-80 - Insignia of Grade, ROTC, Cadets, JROTC Female Officers, Private E-2 to Staff Sergeant
B-3-84 - Insignia of Grade, ROTC, Cadets, Construction Details

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figures 1, 2 and 3 are miniature reproductions of drawings B-3-79, B-3-80 and B-3-84 and are attached for information purposes,)

2.2 Other publications.-

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES, INC.
DOD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1974
United States Army ColorCard, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, Etc.
DOD Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades for Sewing Threads, 1968
Standard Color Card of America, 9th Edition

(Copies of the standards noted above may be obtained from The Color Association of the U.S., Inc., 200 Madison Ave., New York, NY 10016.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Sample.-

3.1.1 Guide sample.- Samples are furnished solely for guidance and information to the contractor. Variations from the requirements of this specification may appear in the guide sample in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 First article.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced six finished sleeves, of each applicable class, shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

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3.2 Materials.-

3.2.1 Cloth, cotton twill.- Except for characteristics listed in table I, the base cloth shall conform to type III or IV of CCC-C-461.

TABLE I Requirements for cotton twill.-

	Minimum	Maximum
Weight (oz. per sq. yd.)	8	-
Yarns per inch:		
Warp	110	-
Filling	54	-
Breaking strength (lb.):		
Warp	110	-
Filling	60	-
Shrinkage (percent):		
Warp	-	2
Filling	-	2

3.2.1.1 Color.- The color of the cotton shall be black, conforming to Cable No. 65018.

3.2.1.1.1 Matching.- The color shall match the standard sample under natural (North Sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 degrees Kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800 degrees Kelvin.

3.2.1.1.2 Sulfur content.- The use of sulfur dyes and dyes containing elementary sulfur or compounds capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuffs shall be chosen and applied so that the cotton twill shall contain no more labile sulfur than the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.3.1.1.

3.2.1.1.3 Colorfastness.- When the standard sample is referenced for colorfastness the dyed twill shall show fastness to water, wet-dry cleaning and light equal to or better than the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.3.1.1. When the standard sample is not referenced for colorfastness the dyed twill shall show good fastness to water, wet-dry cleaning and light.

3.2.2 Thread.- The thread for hemming the sleeves shall conform to type IC2, ticket No. A-3 ply of V-T-276. The thread shall be dyed black, shade AA, Cable No. C.A. 66043 (see 2.2) and shall show fastness to water, wet-dry cleaning and light equal to or better than the standard sample is available, the thread shall show good fastness to water, wet-dry cleaning and light when tested as specified in 4.3.1.1.

3.2.3 Embroidery yarns.- The embroidery yarn shall be Schiffli embroidered and shall conform to the requirements of type I, class 1 of MIL-I-3037 except that the requirements for base cloth shall not apply. The embroidery devices shall be as specified on the applicable cartoons which shall be furnished by the Government. The embroidery yarn shall be dyed Goldenlight HG, Cable No. 67107 and shall show fastness

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to water, wet-dry cleaning and light, equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available the yarn shall show good fastness to water, wet-dry cleaning and light when tested as specified in 4.3.1.1.

3.2.4 Snap fasteners.- The snap fasteners shall conform to style 3, (pronged ring head type), finish 2-black chemical, size 17-line of MIL-F-10884.

3.3 Design.- The design of the shoulder loop sleeve shall be as shown on drawings B-3-79, B-3-80 and B-3-84 with an embroidered device as shown on the applicable drawing.

3.4 Drawings.- Drawings B-3-79, B-3-80 and B-3-84 specify the finished measurements for all eleven classes (see 1.2) of shoulder loop sleeves and illustrate the location of the embroidered device. Construction requirements shall be as shown on drawings B-3-84. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the drawings, the written specification shall govern.

3.5 Construction.-

3.5.1 Embroidering.- The device shall be Schiffli embroidered on cotton twill using yarn specified in 3.2.3. The device shall conform to the applicable cartoons furnished by the Government. The device for each class shall be centered vertically on the base cloth with the ends of the device extending beyond the crease lines as illustrated on drawing B-3-84. The point of the embroidered design shall be in the direction of the warp.

3.5.2 Lacquering.- The shoulder loop sleeves shall be coated on the unfolded back with lacquer which shall give the sleeves a firm and stiff finish. The lacquer shall not effect the color in any way.

3.5.3 Cutting.- The cotton twill material shall be cut so that the finished shoulder loop sleeves will conform to the measurements specified on drawing B-3-79, B-3-80 and B-3-84.

3.5.4 Hemming.- The shoulder loop sleeves shall have a 3/8 to 1/2 inch wide hem on all four sides. The hem shall be stitched 1/16 to 1/8 inch from the turned edge with 10-14 stitches per inch using stitch type 301 and seam type EFa-1 conforming to FED-STD-751. All ends of stitching not caught in other seams or stitching shall be backstitched not less than 1/2 inch.

3.5.5 Creasing.- Fold and crease each sleeve so that there is an overlap in back as shown on drawing B-3-84.

3.5.6 Attaching snap fasteners.- Attach snap fasteners, stud and sockets with the center of the stud and sockets positioned 1 $\pm$ 1/8 inch from each top and bottom edge. The sockets shall be attached through the side hem adjacent to the side edge. Studs shall be so positioned in relation to the side so as to effect a smooth closure without any distortion of the sleeve.

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3.6 Measurements.- The finished measurements of the sleeve after being folded and snapped (see drawing B-3-84) shall be as follows:

Length - 4 ± 1/16 inch
Width across top - 2-3/16 ± 1/16 inch
Width across bottom - 2-3/8 ± 1/16 inch

3.7 Workmanship.- The finished sleeves shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The point of the embroidered design shall be in the direction of the warp.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own, or any other facilities, suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article samples approval.- When first article samples are required, the samples shall be inspected for all provisions applicable to end item examination.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance.- Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components.- In addition to quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials as specified herein. When there is a conflict in quality assurance provisions, this specification shall govern.

4.3.1.1 Testing of components.- Components shall be tested as specified in table II. Test methods listed in table II shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191, wherever applicable. The sample unit for testing shall be 3-1/2 continuous yards full width of the finished cloth. The sample unit for thread and embroidery yarn shall be five continuous yards of each. The sample size shall be as follows, and the lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified.

Lot size (yd)	Sample size (units)
Less than 800	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

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TABLE II Component tests.-

Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method
Cotton twill		
Material identification 3/	3.2.1	1200
Mercerization 3/	3.2.1	Microscopic examination
Singeing 3/	3.2.1	Standard commercial
Weave 1/	3.2.1	Visual
Direction of twill	3.2.1	Visual
Weight	3.2.1	5041
Yarns per inch	3.2.1	5050
Breaking strength(warp and filling)	3.2.1	5100
Shrinkage in laundering 2/	3.2.1	5550
Color 1/	3.2.1.1	Visual
Presence of sulfur 1/, 3/	3.2.1.1.2	2020
Colorfastness to:		
Water	3.2.1.1.3	5630
Wet-dry cleaning	3.2.1.1.3	5622
Light 4/	3.2.1.1.3	5660
Thread		
Colorfastness to:		
Water	3.2.2	5630
Wet-dry cleaning	3.2.2	5622
Light 4/	3.2.2	5660
Embroidery yarn		
Colorfastness to:		
Water	3.2.3	5630
Wet-dry cleaning	3.2.3	5622
Light 4/	3.2.3	5660

1/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the result reported as pass or fail.

2/ The three specimens required for the shrinkage test shall be selected from the cloth (sample unit) as follows: One specimen from the center of the cloth. No two specimens shall contain the same filling yarns. Each elongation value shall be prefixed with a minus sign and both inclosed in parenthesis.

3/ Unless otherwise specified, a contractor's certificate of compliance may be accepted as evidence of conformance.

4/ In the event of a dispute resulting from the test with method 5660, or as a result of suspected anomalous behavior of certain dye types or formulations, the contracting officer may authorize the exposure to natural light in accordance with method 5662.

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4.3.2 Visual examination of the end item.- Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with table III. The sample unit for this examination shall be one sleeve. The acceptable quality level (AQL) for this examination shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units. The inspection level shall be level II of MIL-STD-105.

TABLE III Classification of visual examination defects.-

Examine	Defects
Material defects (base cloth)	Manufacturing defects, such as holes, floats, broken ends or picks, slubs, lumps, knots, stains, streaks, clearly visible. 1/
Device	Any device mispositioned, definitely affecting appearance not underlaid to show a well raised effect.
	Details or device incomplete.
	Wrong color or shade.
Lacquer coating	Omitted from back of sleeve.
	Lacquer stain on face side of sleeve.
Embroidery	Loose tension or tight tension clearly noticeable or resulting in poorly defined design.
	Embroidered device not extending beyond the creased line.
	Stitching incomplete (miss).
	Point of embroidered design not in the direction of the warp.
	Ragged, broken or loose stieles clearly noticeable.
	Stieles or embroidery stitching missing.
	Any shift seriously affecting appearance.
Workmanship	Spot or stain clearly noticeable.
	Misshapen or distorted insignia, affecting appearance.
Seams and stitching	Loose ends not backstitched a minimum of 1/2 inch.
	Loose tension, noticeably affecting appearance.
	Tight tension, i.e., fabric puckers excessively.
	Seam crooked or irregular affecting appearance.
	Finished hem not 3/8 to 1/2 inch in width.
	Stitching on hems not 1/16 to 1/8 inch from turned edge.
	Less than 10 or more than 14 stitches per inch.
	Wrong stitch type.
Snap fastener	Any socket or stud insecurely attached, clinched or damaged not serving intended purpose.
	Stud or socket not positioned 7/8 inch to 1-1/8 inch from each top and bottom edge.
	Stud and socket not properly aligned causing noticeable bulge or distortion of sleeve.
	Snap fasteners defective, e.g., cannot be closed.
	Snap fasteners missing or defective.
	Snap fasteners clinched too tight, i.e., cuts surrounding material.
Pressing	Singed or scorched.
	Clearly visible creases or gloss marks.

1/ At normal inspection distance (16 to 22 inches)

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4.3.3 Examination for measurements.- Any measurement exceeding the specified dimension (including tolerance) shall be considered a defect. The sample unit for this examination shall be one finsihed sleeve after being folded and snapped. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units and the sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level S-3. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sleeve each.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV Classification of preparation for delivery defects.-

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any compoment missing. Any component damaged
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as, incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.
Content	Number of bundles per intermediate box is more or less than required. 1/ Number of intermediate boxes per shipping container is more or less than required. Number of insignia per bundle is more or less than required. 2/

1/ For this defect, one intermediate box shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

2/ For this defect, one bundle shall be examined from the intermediate box selected for determination of number of bundles.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be levels A and C.

5.1.1 Level A.-

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.- Five pair of one class only, with snap fasteners engaged, shall be neatly stacked in a bundle and securely tied with cotton tape or twine.

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5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging.- Ten bundles (50 pairs) of one class only shall be packaged in 5.1.1.1, and placed in a snug-fitting transparent polyehtylene bag. All seams and closures shall be a minimum of .0015 inch thick. All seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.2 Level C.- Insignia shall be packaged to afford an adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving station. The supplier may use his commercial practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to W5c, W5s, style RSC, W3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of container specification.

5.2.2 Level B.- Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to type SF, class Domestic, grades 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C.- Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rates for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packages, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Labels, mixed classes.- Each shipping container packed with mixed classes shall have securely attached to the end and side a 5 by 4 inch, white paper label with the words MIXED CLASSES plainly printed thereon and under these words shall legibly be printed the correct quantity and classes contained therein.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The shoulder loop sleeve, Insignia of grade are intended for use by the Army, NCO, ROTC Cadets and JROTC Female Officers.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:
(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Class required (see 1.2).
(c) When first article samples are required (see 3.1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1, 5.2).

Custodians:
Army - IH
Review Activities:
Other - DP
User Activities:
Army - SM
Project No. 8455-A389

Preparing Activity:

The Institute of Heraldry,
United States Army

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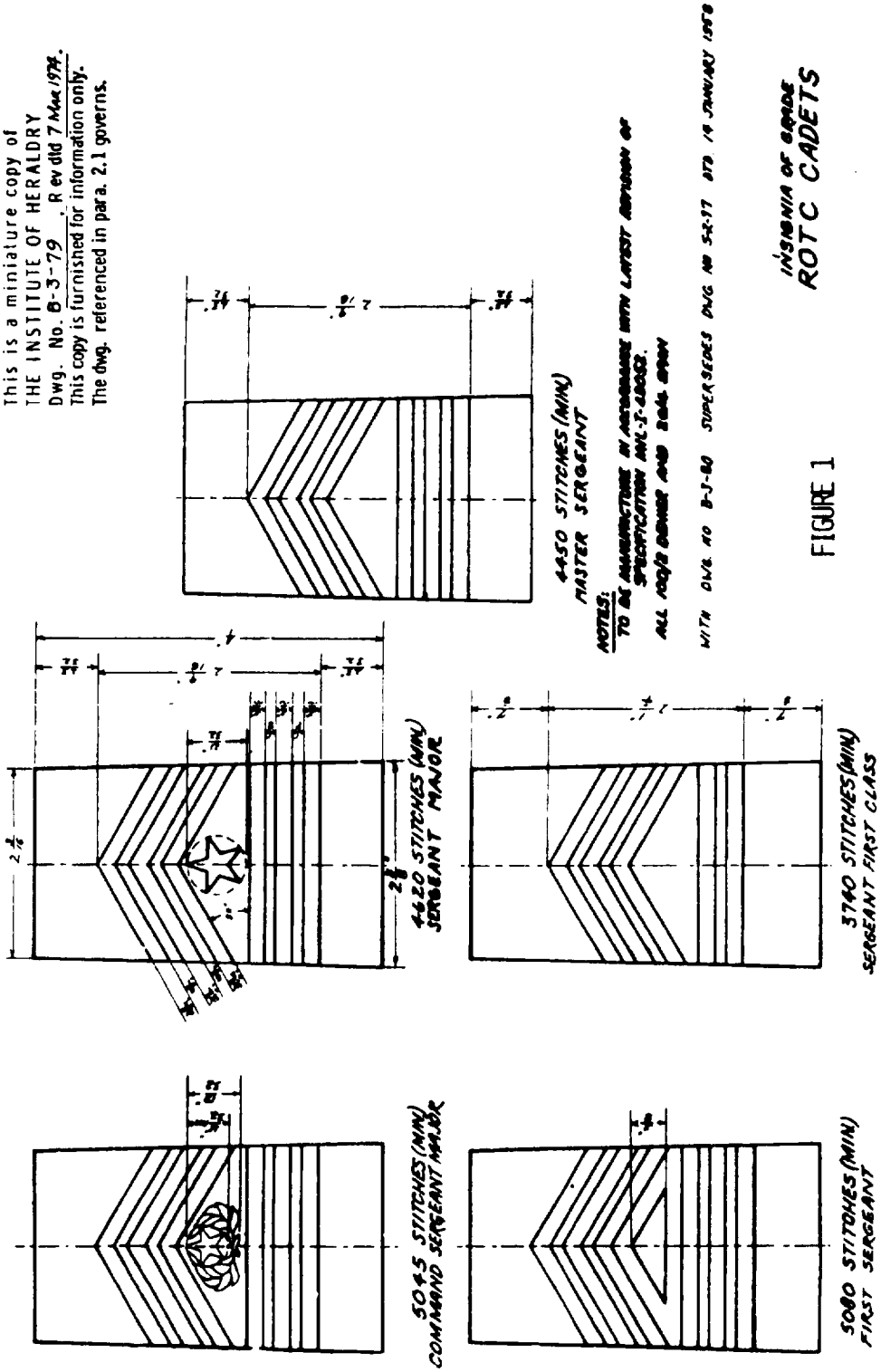


FIGURE 1

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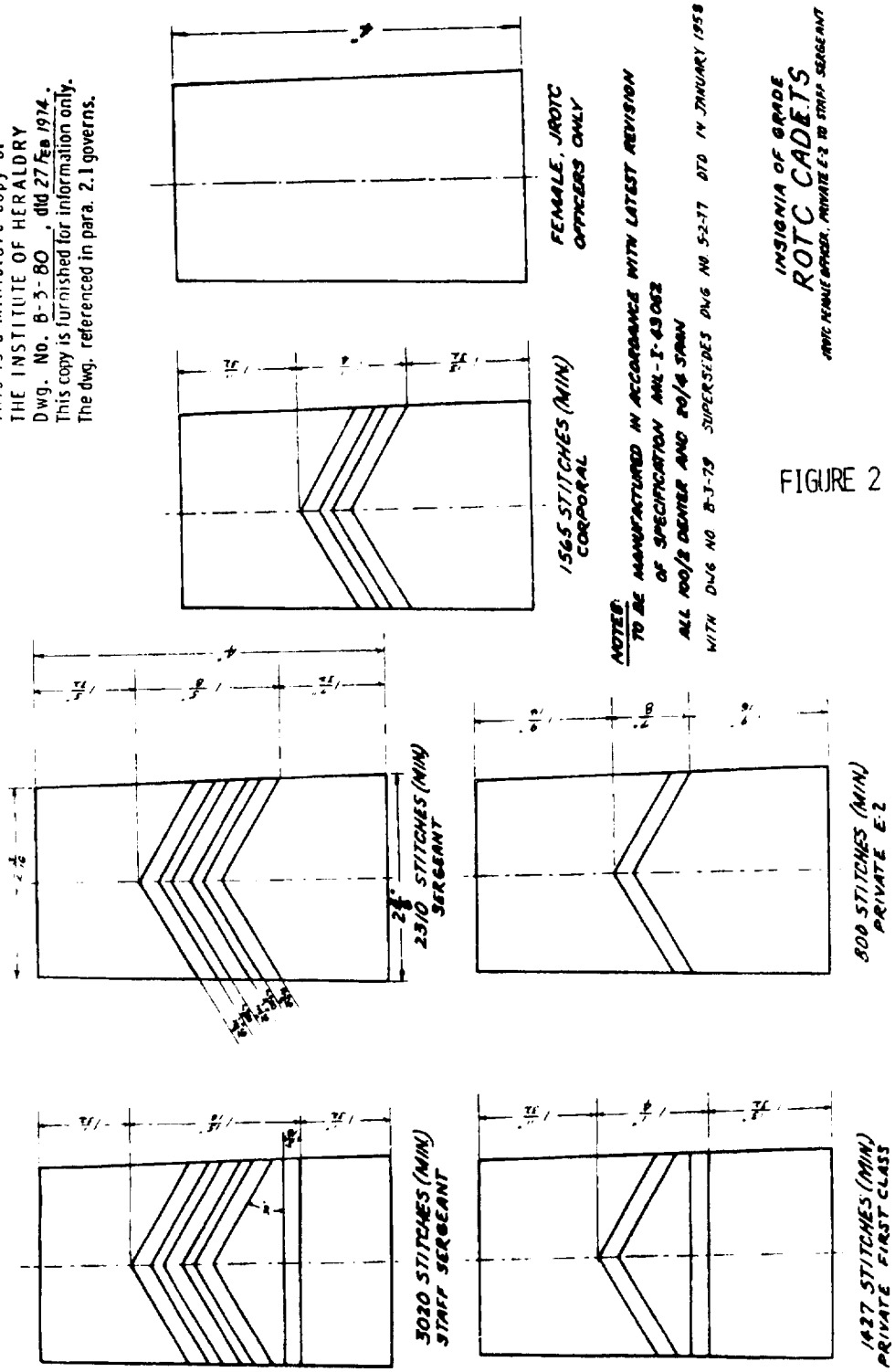


FIGURE 2

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INSIGNIA OF GRADE
ROTC CADETS
CONSTRUCTION DETAILS

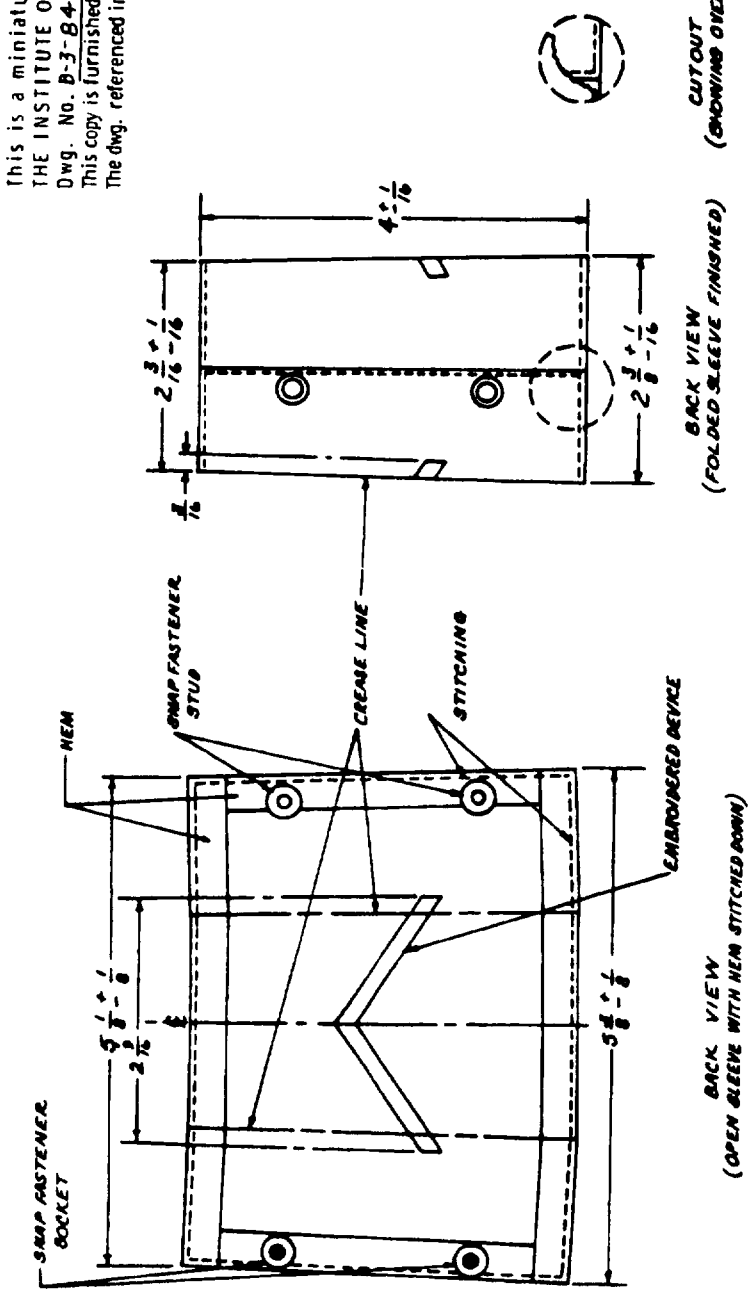


FIGURE 3

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

MIL-I-43052A(IH) Insignia, Grade, Shoulder Loop Sleeve, ROTC & JROTC, A

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1 OCT 64 1426

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